03-24 第1篇

阅读理解（说明文） Why Onions Make Us Cry

① In almost every kitchen in China, there is a small quiet moment: Mum or Dad picks up a knife, starts to cut an onion, and suddenly begins to **blink, sniff, and wipe their eyes**. No one is sad. No one is watching a film. It is only a little round vegetable — and yet, it has made cooks cry for thousands of years. Why?

② The answer hides **inside the onion itself**. When the onion is sitting on the table, it looks calm and safe. But inside its thin white layers, two things are stored: first, **sulphur** compounds made in the soil; second, special **enzymes** that help the plant protect itself. As long as the onion is whole, these two things never meet. The moment a knife cuts in, the cells break, and the two parts mix at last. Together, they make a small, invisible gas called **syn-propanethial-S-oxide**. This gas rises quickly into the air — and straight towards our face.

③ So how does this gas lead to tears? When the gas touches the thin, wet surface of our eyes, it slowly turns into a weak acid. Our eyes do not like acid at all. They have a clever **alarm system**: special glands quickly send out extra tears to **wash the acid away** and protect the eyes. That is the reason tears come before we can even say "finished". It is not sadness; it is **self-protection**.

④ If onions really upset our eyes, can we cook without crying? The answer is yes, and there are several simple tricks. First, **chill** the onion in the fridge for about 30 minutes before cutting. A colder onion sends up gas more slowly, giving our eyes more time to blink the gas away. Second, use a **sharp knife**, not a blunt one. A sharp knife cuts cleanly and breaks fewer cells, so less gas is set free. Third, **cut near a running water tap or an open window**; the moving air carries the gas away from your face. Some cooks even wear small swimming goggles — strange-looking, but surprisingly useful.

⑤ So next time you see Dad standing at the kitchen counter with wet eyes, do not rush to ask, "What's wrong?" Smile, hand him a tissue, and remember: behind those tears is simple, silent chemistry — a small reminder that **science is quietly mixed into our dinner**, every evening of the week.

根据文章内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What is the main topic of the article?

A. How to choose the best onions at the market.
B. Why onions make us cry and how to avoid it.
C. The history of onion farming in China.
D. How to cook a tasty onion dish for the family.

2. When do the sulphur compounds and the enzymes in an onion meet?

A. Before the onion is cut.
B. When the onion is still in the soil.
C. The moment a knife cuts into the onion.
D. Only when the onion is cooked in oil.

3. Why do our eyes produce tears when the gas from the onion reaches them?

A. The gas has a strong sweet taste.
B. The eyes want to enjoy the cool feeling.
C. The gas turns into a weak acid, and tears wash it away.
D. The gas makes the brain feel sad.

4. Which of the following is NOT a good way to cut an onion without crying?

A. Keeping the onion warm on the stove for 30 minutes first.
B. Chilling the onion in the fridge before cutting.
C. Using a sharp knife.
D. Cutting near a running water tap or an open window.

5. What is the writer's main idea in the last paragraph?

A. Everyone should avoid cooking with onions.
B. Science is quietly part of our everyday life, even at dinner.
C. Dads are the best cooks in the family.
D. Wearing goggles is always the best solution in the kitchen.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】全文围绕"为什么洋葱让人流泪"及"如何避免"
【解析】核心为成因+对策。A、C、D 非主题。故选 B。

2.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题

【定位】第②段 "The moment a knife cuts in, the cells break"
【解析】刀切入时才相遇。A、B、D 与原文不符。故选 C。

3.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段 "weak acid... tears to wash the acid away"
【解析】气体形成弱酸，泪液冲洗。A、B、D 与原文不符。故选 C。

4.
【答案】A
【题型】细节否定题
【定位】第④段三条技巧：冷藏、锋利、通风
【解析】"加热洋葱"不在技巧中，且与"冷藏使气体慢"相反。B、C、D 都属文中方法。故选 A。

5.
【答案】B
【题型】主旨推断题
【定位】第⑤段末 "science is quietly mixed into our dinner"
【解析】科学融入日常晚餐。A、C、D 与主旨不符。故选 B。

词汇注释（超纲词）

- **sulphur** [n.] 硫（元素）
- **enzyme** [n.] 酶
- **goggles** [n.] 护目镜